

Manhattan's Official Culture, Neighborhood by Neighborhood, Run Forward 20 Years (2021 → 2041)

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A Forecast, Sketched · Assignment 3 · Giovanna Pillaca · GSAPP, Fall 2026 · builds on Assignment 2: "Where Is Manhattan's Official Culture?"

1 · Question

How might Manhattan's official cultural organizations change, neighborhood by neighborhood, from **2021 to 2041**, and does being near the subway matter?

Checkpoints: **2026 (today), 2031, 2041**. A sketch, not a prediction.

Why: the city's list stopped updating in June 2021, so it can't show what has happened since.

2 · Dataset

DCLA Cultural Organizations, NYC Department of Cultural Affairs, NYC Open Data (u35m-9t32). Published Nov 2018, last updated June 2021. Lists the organizations the agency works with or funds. 2,535 rows citywide; $\approx 1,250$ – $1,300$ in Manhattan with coordinates.

MTA Subway Stations, data.ny.gov (39hk-dx4f).

Station locations, used to tag each organization near or far from the subway.

Column	Type / unit
Organization Name	text (row ID)
Discipline	category (Dance or other)
Latitude, Longitude	decimal degrees
NTA*	neighborhood name
near_subway (A2)	yes / no: $\leq 1,320$ ft from a station (85% yes)

3 · Research

NEA / Urban Institute (2013): arts nonprofits in 6 U.S. metro areas (not New York), 1990–2010.

- All arts organizations: 62% survived 20 years → **2.362%/yr** closure
- Dance: 55% survived → **2.945%/yr**

Annual rate: $p = 1 - 5^{1/20}$

Caution: "survival" means still filing an IRS Form 990 with $\geq \$50,000$ revenue; losses include mergers.

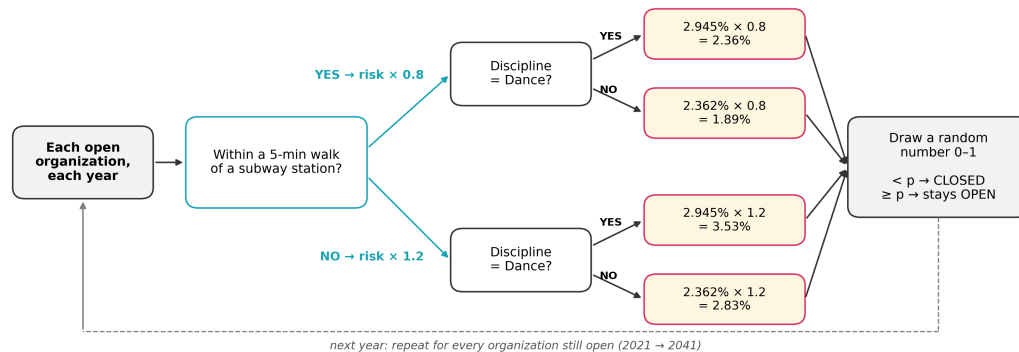
Subway: linked to higher cultural attendance (PLOS ONE, 2025). No study links it to survival; the subway factor is my assumption.

4 · Starting record

All Manhattan organizations in June 2021, set to "open" (Assignment 2 map).



5 · Rule: each open organization, each year



$p(\text{close}) = \text{base rate} \times \text{subway factor}$

Number	Value	Source
Base rate, dance	2.945% / yr	NEA
Base rate, other	2.362% / yr	NEA
Near subway	$\times 0.8$	me [least sure]
Far from subway	$\times 1.2$	me [least sure]
Non-NY rates used for Manhattan	same	me [least sure]
Walk radius	1,320 ft (5 min)	me

* **NTA** = Neighborhood Tabulation Area: NYC Planning's 2020 neighborhood zones, used in the Assignment 2 map and included in the DCLA data.

6 · Run

- 1-year steps, 2021 → 2041 (20 steps).
- **Run A, expected:** each organization’s share still open $\times (1 - p)$ every year.
- **Run B, random:** 100 runs; each year an organization closes if its random draw is below p . Keep the middle 90%.
- **Tests:** subway factor on vs. off; one base rate for all.
- **Reality check:** look up 10 organizations to see which are open in 2026.

8 · Limits

- Closures only: no openings or moves.
- Ignores rent, funding, the pandemic and organization size.
- Rates come from other cities and larger groups.
- Neighborhood boundaries and stations stay fixed.

Sources

NEA / Urban Institute (2013):
arts.gov/sites/default/files/Research-Art-Works-Harvard.pdf
PLOS ONE (2025): doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0334642
DCLA Cultural Organizations: data.cityofnewyork.us (u35m-9t32)
MTA Subway Stations: data.ny.gov (39hk-dx4f)

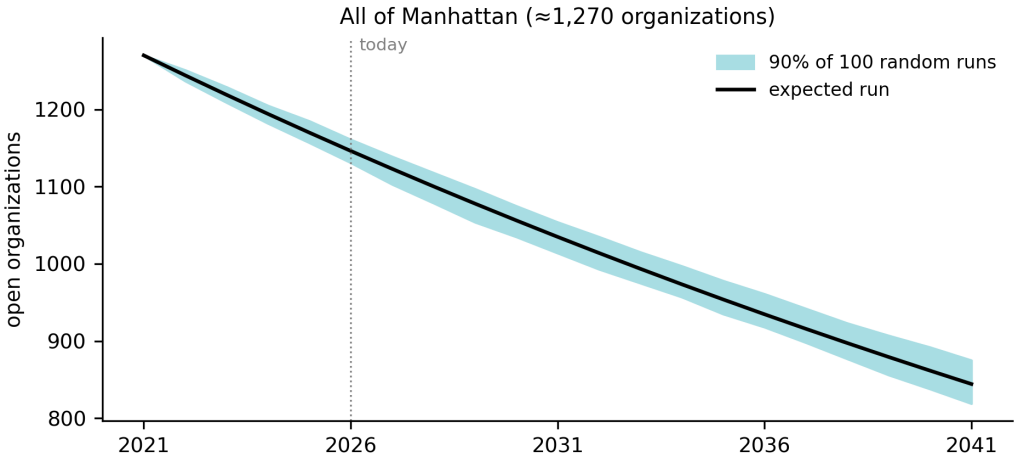
7 · Output

One row per organization per year (Run B). **New columns:** run, year, p, random, status, year_closed.

run	year	name	discipline	NTA*	near	p	random	status	year_closed
17	2022	1687, Inc.	Multi-Disc.	West Village	yes	0.0189	0.412	open	-
17	2022	20/20 Vision for Schools	Visual Arts	East Village	yes	0.0189	0.013	closed	2022
...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...	...

Open organizations per neighborhood:

NTA*	2021	2026	2031	2041	2041 range (90%)
Midtown-Times Square	149	≈ 134	≈ 121	≈ 99	90 - 109
East Village	95	≈ 86	≈ 77	≈ 63	55 - 71



Illustrative values, not results: all organizations non-dance, 85% near a station.